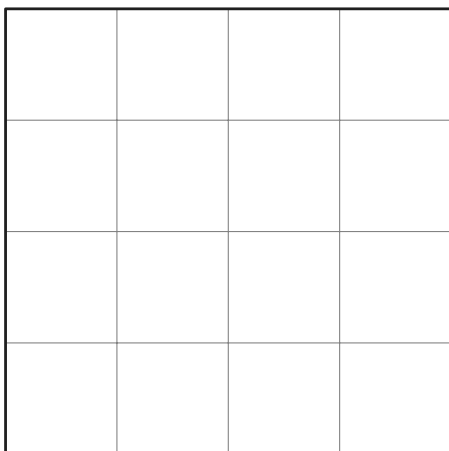
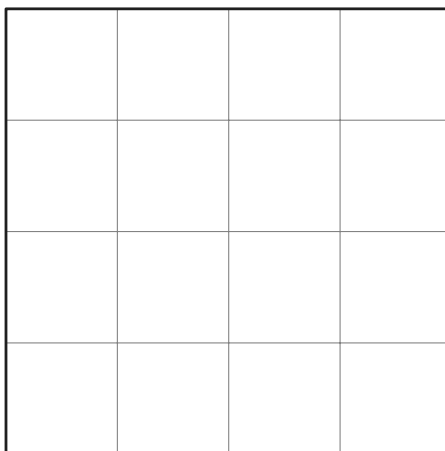
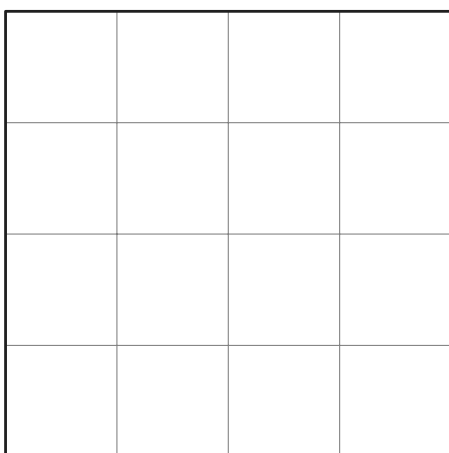
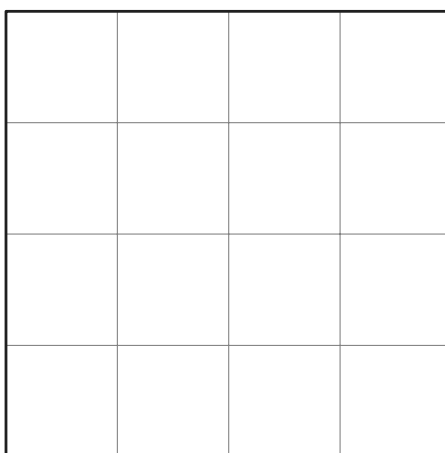


Problem 1: A domino is a rectangle that covers exactly two squares sharing a side. Cover board A with 8 dominoes so that every square is covered exactly once and nothing sticks out past the edge. Then draw your dominoes on the board: outline each domino. Cover board B in a different way and draw it. Cover board C using exactly 2 vertical dominoes and 6 horizontal ones, and draw it. Then try to cover board D using exactly 3 vertical dominoes and 5 horizontal ones. Write ✓ in the box marked D if you did it and × if you could not.

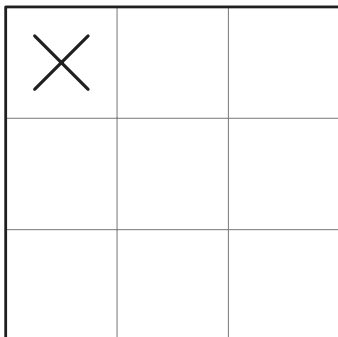
A**B****C****D**

D

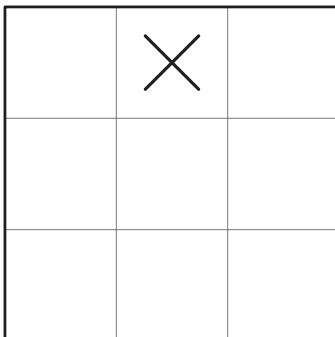
☐

Problem 2: Each board below is a 3-by-3 board with one square crossed out. Cover the 8 remaining squares with 4 dominoes if you can, and draw the dominoes. Write $\checkmark$ in the box under the board if you covered it and $\times$ if you cannot.

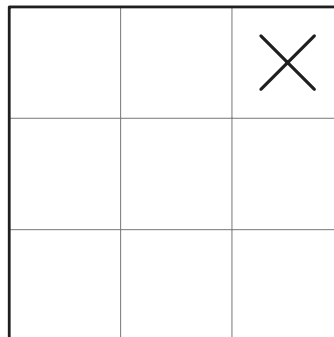
(a)


☐

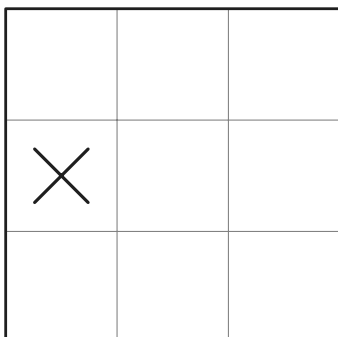
(b)


☐

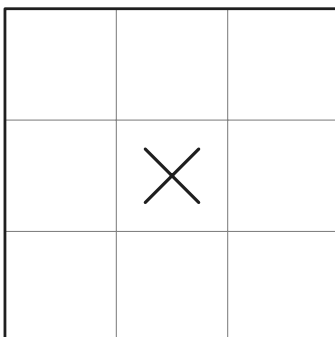
(c)


☐

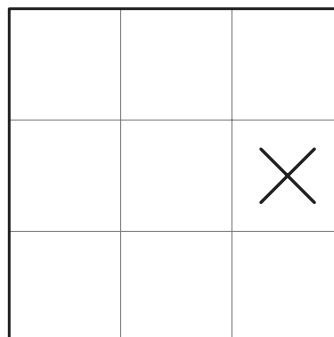
(d)


☐

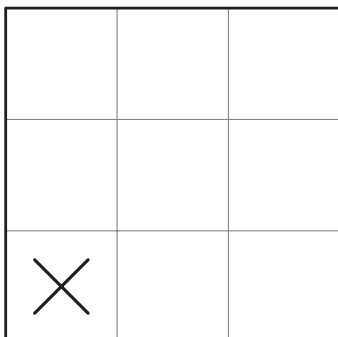
(e)


☐

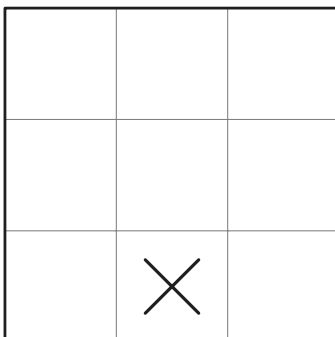
(f)


☐

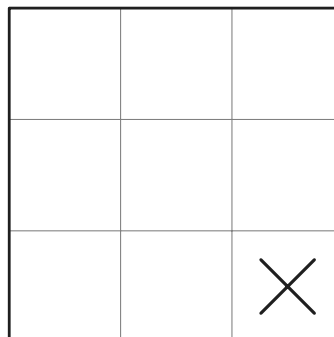
(g)


☐

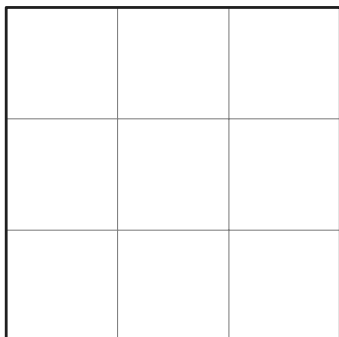
(h)


☐

(i)


☐

Problem 3: Color the 3-by-3 board below like a checkerboard: the top-left square dark, and no two squares that share a side the same color. Write how many dark squares and how many light squares there are. Then put one domino anywhere on the colored board and write in the table how many dark and how many light squares it covers. Do this for three different positions.



dark squares:

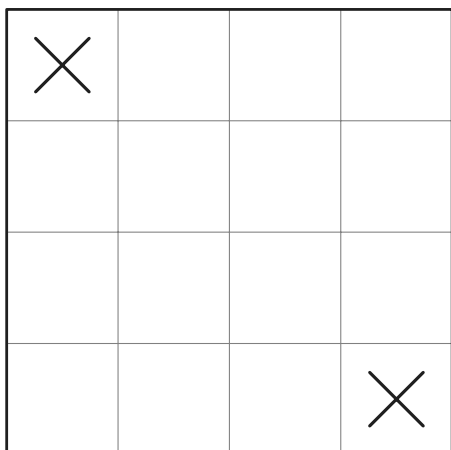
light squares:

domino	dark	light
position 1		
position 2		
position 3		

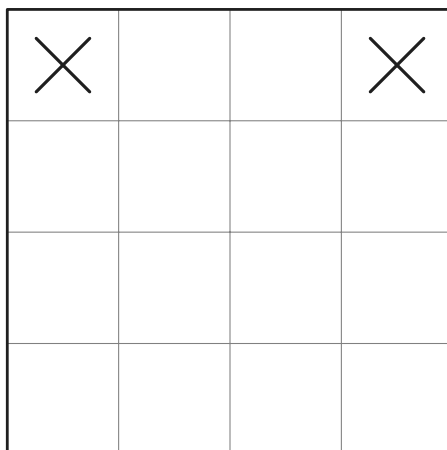
Problem 4: Explain why the boards you marked $\times$ in Problem 2 cannot be covered. Use the counts from Problem 3.

Problem 5: Each 4-by-4 board below has two squares crossed out. For each board, before touching any pieces, write in the table how many dark and how many light squares are left (color the board like a checkerboard if you need to) and your prediction, $\checkmark$ or $\times$. Then check with dominoes and write $\checkmark$ or $\times$ in the result column.

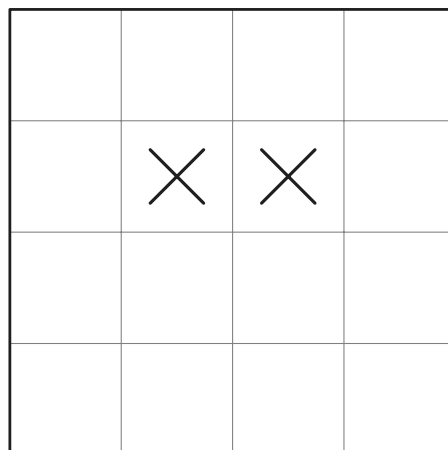
(a)



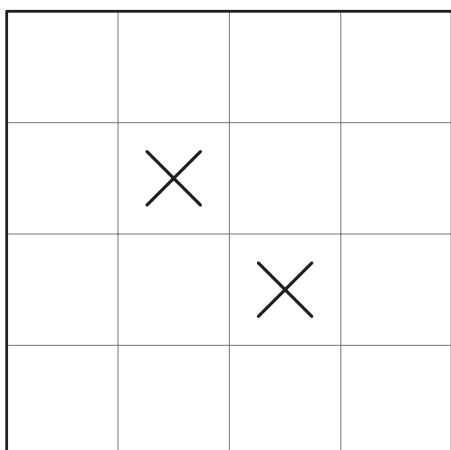
(b)



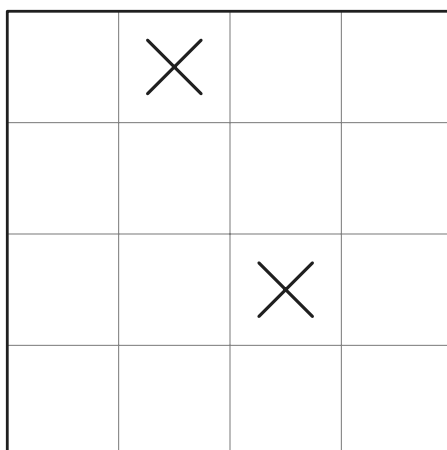
(c)



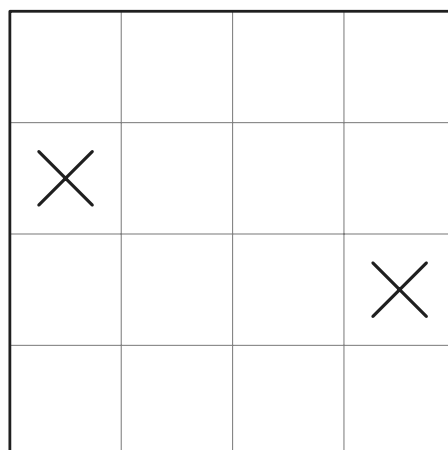
(d)



(e)

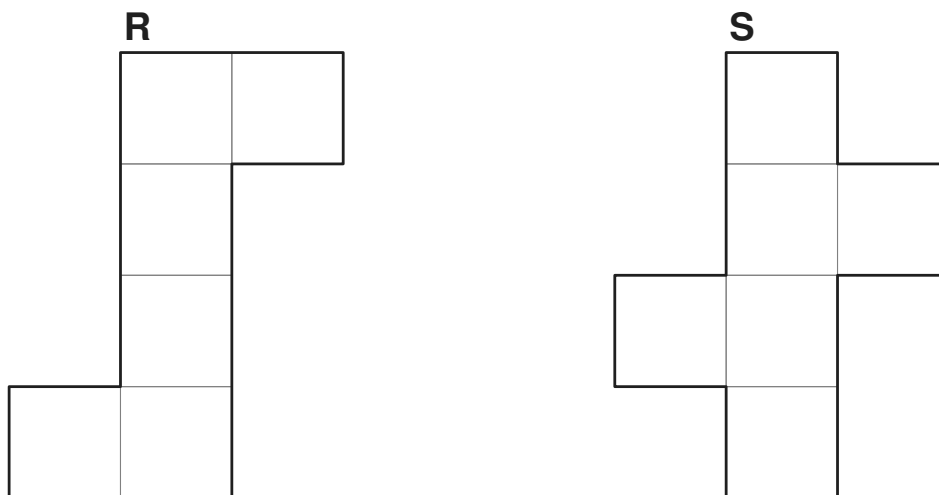


(f)



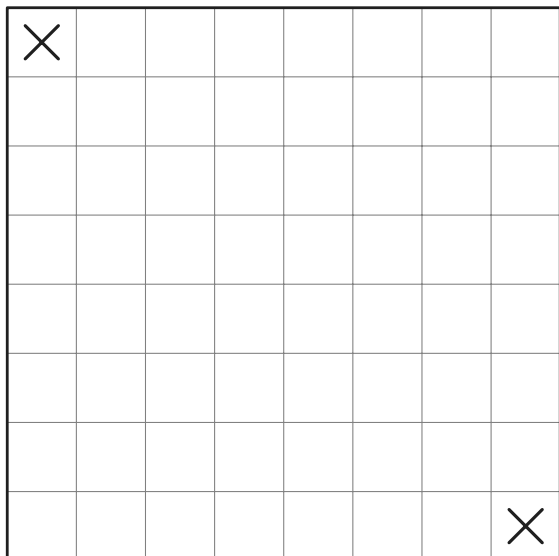
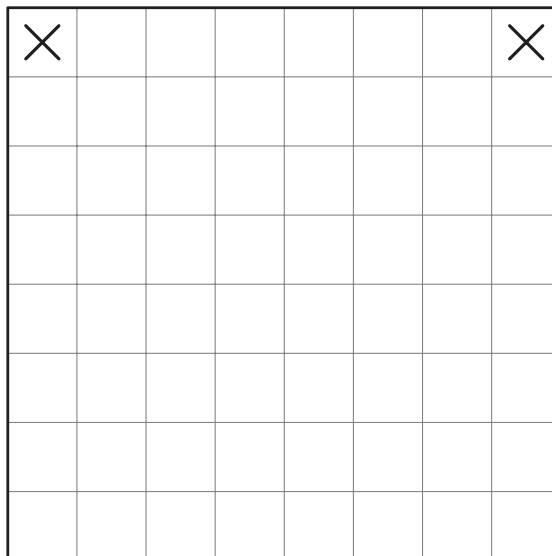
board	dark left	light left	prediction	result
(a)				
(b)				
(c)				
(d)				
(e)				
(f)				

Problem 6: Color boards R and S like a checkerboard and write in the table how many dark and how many light squares each board has. Then try to cover each board with 3 dominoes. Write $\checkmark$ or $\times$ in the last column. For the board marked $\times$, explain on the lines why it is impossible.



board	dark	light	$\checkmark$ or $\times$
R			
S			

Problem 7: Board T is an 8-by-8 board with two opposite corners crossed out. Board U has two corners on the same side crossed out. Without using pieces, write $\checkmark$ or $\times$ in the box next to each board's letter below, and give your reason on the lines under it. For any board you marked $\checkmark$, draw a covering on it.

T**U**

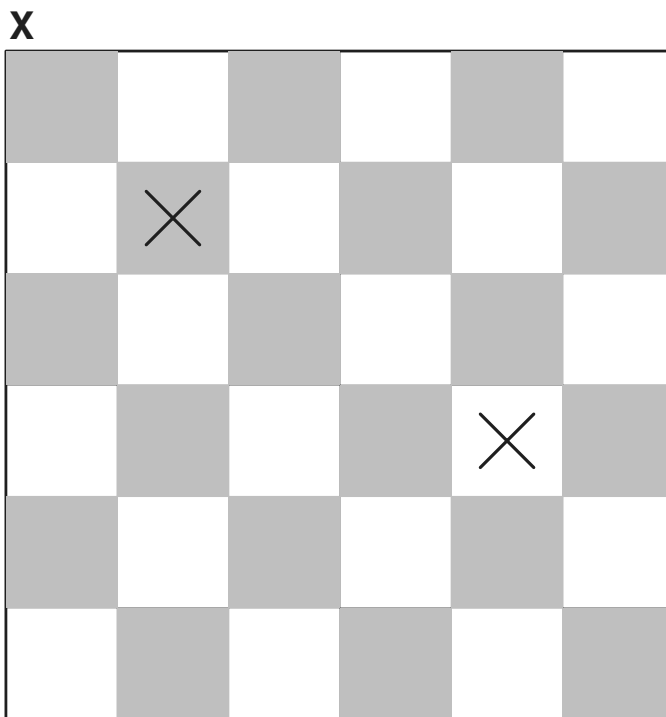
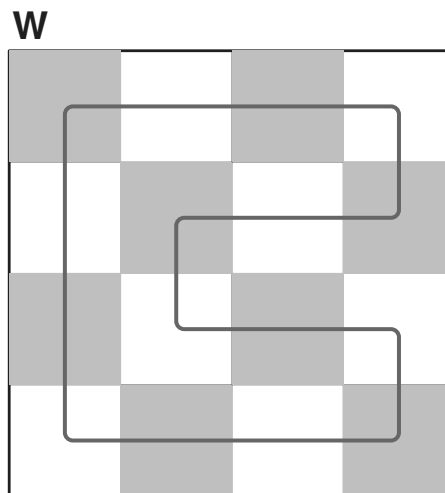
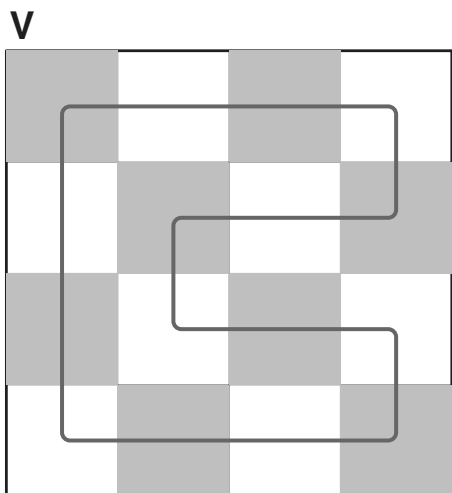
T

☐

U

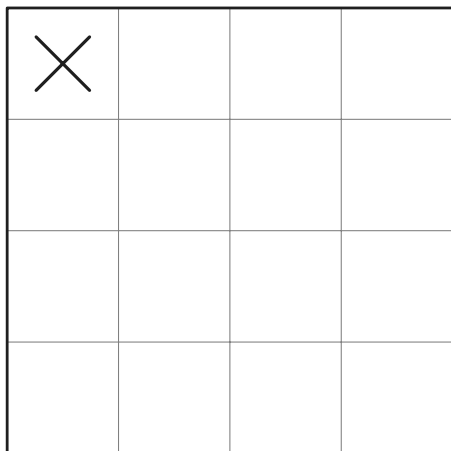
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Problem 8: Board V is a 4-by-4 board with a closed path drawn through all 16 squares. Cross out any one dark square and any one light square (your choice). Then cover all the other squares with dominoes by following the path: each domino covers two squares that are next to each other along the path. Draw the dominoes. Do it again on board W with a different pair. Then draw your own closed path through all 36 squares of board X and use it to cover board X, which already has two squares crossed out. Explain on the lines why the path method always works when one dark and one light square are crossed out.

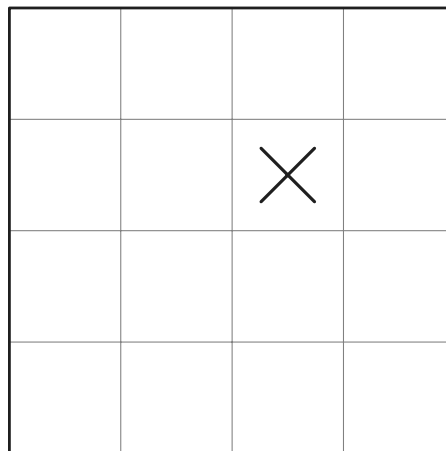


Problem 9: An L-tromino covers three squares of a 2-by-2 block: the block with one square missing. Each board below is 4-by-4 with one square crossed out; on boards (a) and (b) the square is already chosen. Cover each board with 5 L-trominoes and draw them. On boards (c) and (d), first cross out a square of your own choice, then cover. Write on the line whether you found a square that makes covering impossible.

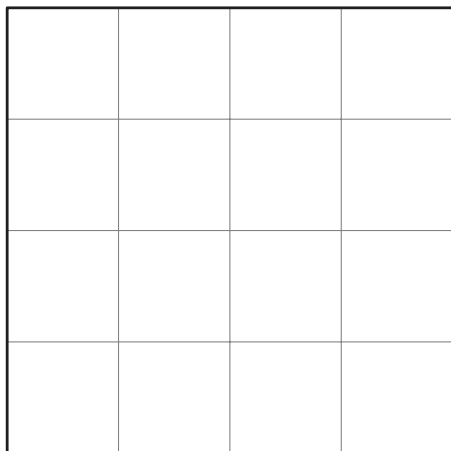
(a)



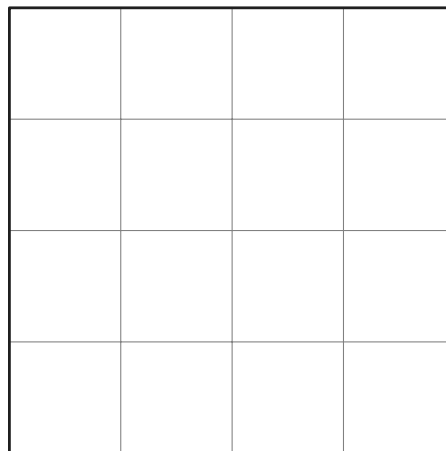
(b)



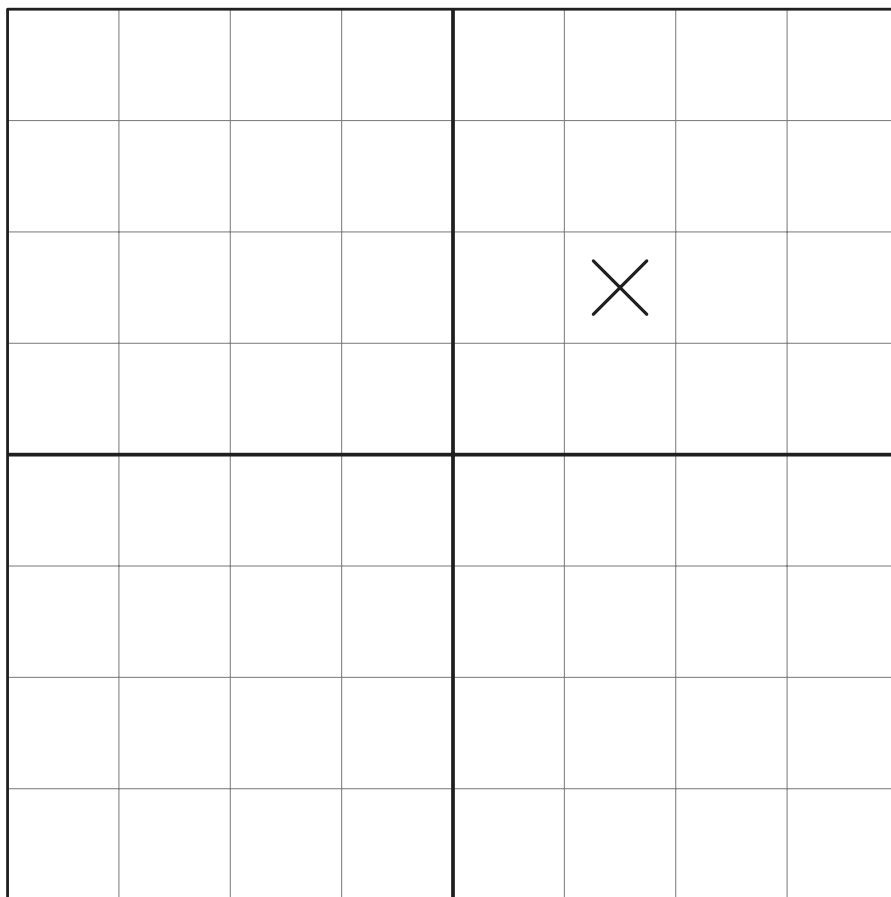
(c)



(d)



Problem 10: Board Z is an 8-by-8 board with one square crossed out. Cover it with 21 L-trominoes by this plan. The thick lines split the board into four 4-by-4 quarters. Put one L-tromino in the middle of the board so that it covers one square in each of the three quarters that do not contain the crossed-out square. Now every quarter is a 4-by-4 board with one square missing: repeat the plan inside each quarter, using its four 2-by-2 blocks. Draw all 21 trominoes. Then write on the lines how you would cover a 16-by-16 board with one square crossed out, without doing it, and how many trominoes it would take.

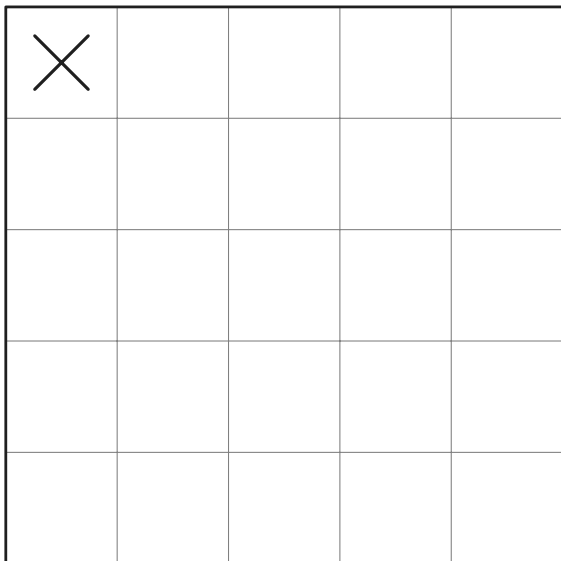
Z

Problem 11: How many different ways are there to cover a 2-by-1 board, a 2-by-2 board, a 2-by-3 board, a 2-by-4 board and a 2-by-5 board with dominoes? Draw every way on the small boards (there are more small boards than you need) and write the number of ways for each size in its box. Then write on the lines your prediction for a 2-by-6 board, and how you can be sure that you found every way for the 2-by-4 board.

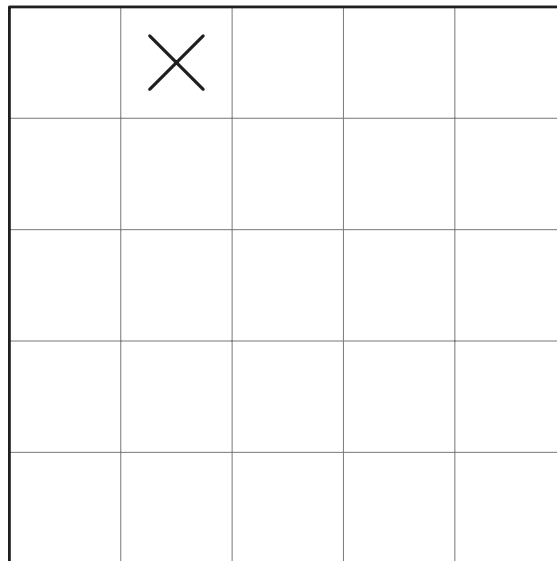
2-by-1					
2-by-2					
2-by-3					
2-by-4					
2-by-5					

Problem 12: Each board below is 5-by-5 with one square crossed out, so 24 squares are left and 8 L-trominoes would be needed. Cover each board if you can and draw the trominoes. Write $\checkmark$ in the box under the board if you covered it and $\times$ if you cannot.

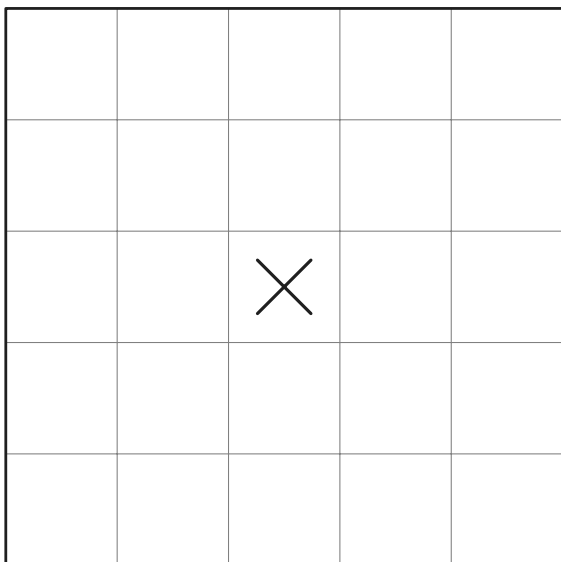
(a)



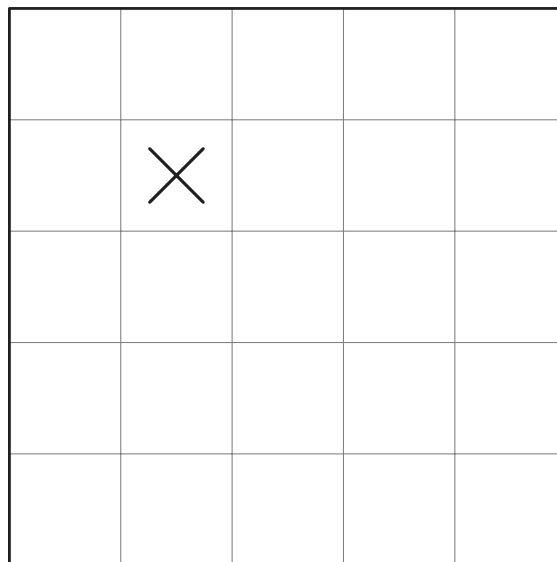
(b)



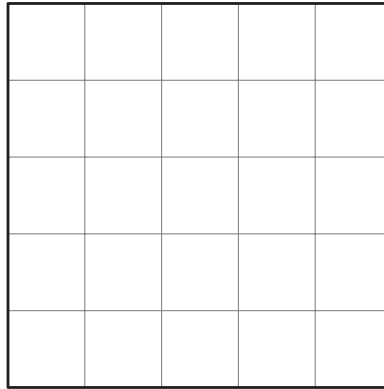
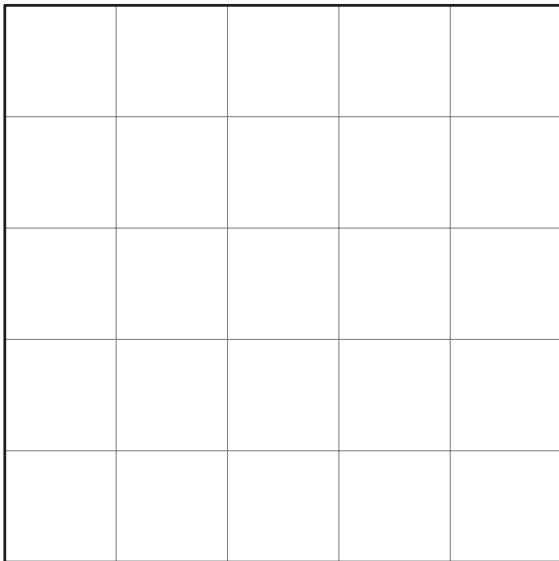
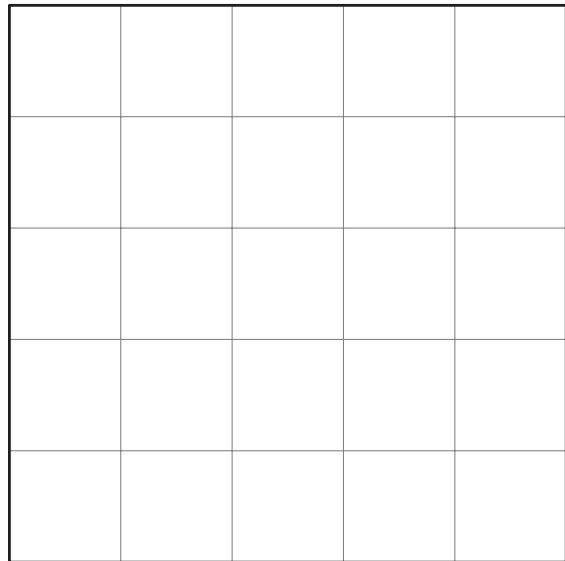
(c)



(d)



Problem 13: The small board below is a map of the 5-by-5 board. Write $\checkmark$ in every square of the map that can be crossed out and still leave a board you can cover with 8 L-trominoes, and $\times$ in every square that cannot. Begin with the four squares you tested in Problem 12. To test another square, cross it out on one of the two blank boards and try to cover the rest.

map**(e)****(f)**

Problem 14: Board Y is an 8-by-8 board with two squares crossed out: the top-left corner and the square in row 4, column 5. Draw a closed path through all 64 squares, ignoring the crosses. Then cover every square except the two crossed-out ones with dominoes, following your path. Then write on the lines whether the path method would work if the two crossed-out squares were both dark, and why.

Y